

Jaishankar's visit to China reflects a thaw in ties — there will be challenges

Five years after the military **standoff** between India and China along the Line of Actual Control (LAC), External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar's **meetings** with China's President Xi Jinping, Foreign Minister Wang Yi, and Liu Jianchao (head of the International Department of the Chinese Communist Party) **signal** an **intent** to repair the relationship with Beijing. Minister Jaishankar's **visit** to China this week — his first since the 2020 **skirmishes** — for the SCO Council of Foreign Ministers meeting, taken **alongside** recent **instances** of **widening** engagement, **reflects** a thaw in **bilateral** ties. Recall that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Xi met **on the sidelines** of the BRICS **summit** last October, shortly after a new border **patrolling** arrangement was announced and a few days before the **disengagement** process officially **concluded**. Since then, NSA Ajit Doval, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, and Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri have all visited China. Other **signs** that the India-China relationship has been moving in a positive direction **include** an understanding to **expedite** the **restoration** of direct flights and easing of visa restrictions, and **resumption** of the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra. While Jaishankar has said that "a **far-seeing lens**" should be used for rebuilding ties, some **key** issues remain **unresolved**.

Post-disengagement, the de-escalation process — the withdrawal of **troops** from forward positions — **hasn't** begun at the border. China's restrictive trade **practices**, such as **curbs** on critical exports like rare earth magnets and high-tech manufacturing machinery, **continue** to be a **stumbling block**. These concerns were **conveyed** by Jaishankar to Wang, along with a **pointed reminder** that the SCO was founded to fight "three evils": Terrorism, **separatism**, and **extremism**. At the same time, in an increasingly **turbulent** world **order**, and especially with an **unpredictable occupant** of the White House, **re-engagement** with China, or what Wang recently described as a "cooperative **pas de deux** of the dragon and the elephant", **is pragmatic** policy. For example, **the US and NATO** threatening to **sanction** countries doing business with Russia — a move that would hit India and China hardest — **underscores** the need for a partnership. The fact, however, is that China continues to view its relationship with India primarily through a lens of competition, not cooperation. The most recent example is China's growing military cooperation with Pakistan during Operation Sindoor. The power gap is also widening. India runs a **trade deficit** of over \$100 billion with China. **The latter** continues to **scale up** its defence budget and capabilities. China also leads in critical technologies like AI, **quantum computing**, and rare earths. And Beijing is **steadily strengthening** its influence across South Asia, **luring** countries strategically important to India into its own **fold** — Bangladesh, most recently.

India must, therefore, remain **vigilant**. Alongside **dialogue**, to increase its **leverage**, New Delhi must focus on **getting its own house in order**: **Accelerate** economic reform, bolster technological capacity, and **foster** social and political unity. Some members of the Opposition have **criticised** Jaishankar's China **outreach**. His **calibrated diplomacy**, however, was necessary. The China question demands long-term, strategic clarity at the domestic level as well. And on the foreign policy **front**, New Delhi must

widen its engagement across the **neighbourhood** and beyond, to prevent Beijing from **gaining a decisive upper hand** in the region. [\[Practice Exercise\]](#)

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

1. **Reflect** (verb) – Indicate, show, demonstrate, represent, mirror प्रतिबिंबित करना
2. **Thaw** (noun) – Relaxation, easing, improvement, softening, detente संबंधों में सुधार
3. **Standoff** (noun) – Deadlock, impasse, stalemate, gridlock, standoff गतिरोध
4. **Signal** (verb) – Indicate, show, announce, convey, gesture संकेत देना
5. **Intent** (noun) – Purpose, aim, goal, objective, resolve इरादा
6. **Skirmish** (noun) – Clash, fight, encounter, scuffle, conflict झड़प
7. **Alongside** (adverb) – Beside, together with, in parallel, simultaneously, accompanying साथ-साथ
8. **Instance** (noun) – Example, case, occurrence, illustration, occasion उदाहरण
9. **Widening** (adjective) – Expanding, broadening, increasing, growing, extending बढ़ते हुए
10. **Bilateral** (adjective) – Two-sided, mutual, reciprocal, joint, collaborative द्विपक्षीय
11. **On the sidelines of** (phrase) – In parallel to, during, concurrently with, on the margin of, alongside के दौरान में
12. **Summit** (noun) – Conference, meeting, assembly, convention, conclave शिखर सम्मेलन
13. **Patrolling** (noun) – Monitoring, guarding, surveillance, inspection, watch गश्त
14. **Disengagement** (noun) – Withdrawal, detachment, separation, retreat, pullout विघटन
15. **Conclude** (verb) – End, finish, close, wrap up, terminate समाप्त करना
16. **Expedite** (verb) – Hasten, accelerate, quicken, facilitate, advance तेजी से करना
17. **Restoration** (noun) – Reinstatement, return, revival, repair, renewal पुनर्स्थापना
18. **Resumption** (noun) – Restart, recommencement, renewal, continuation, reinitiation फिर से शुरू होना
19. **Far-seeing** (adjective) – Visionary, foresighted, prudent, strategic, wise दूरदर्शी
20. **Lens** (noun) – Perspective, viewpoint, outlook, angle, frame दृष्टिकोण
21. **Key** (adjective) – Crucial, important, vital, significant, essential महत्वपूर्ण

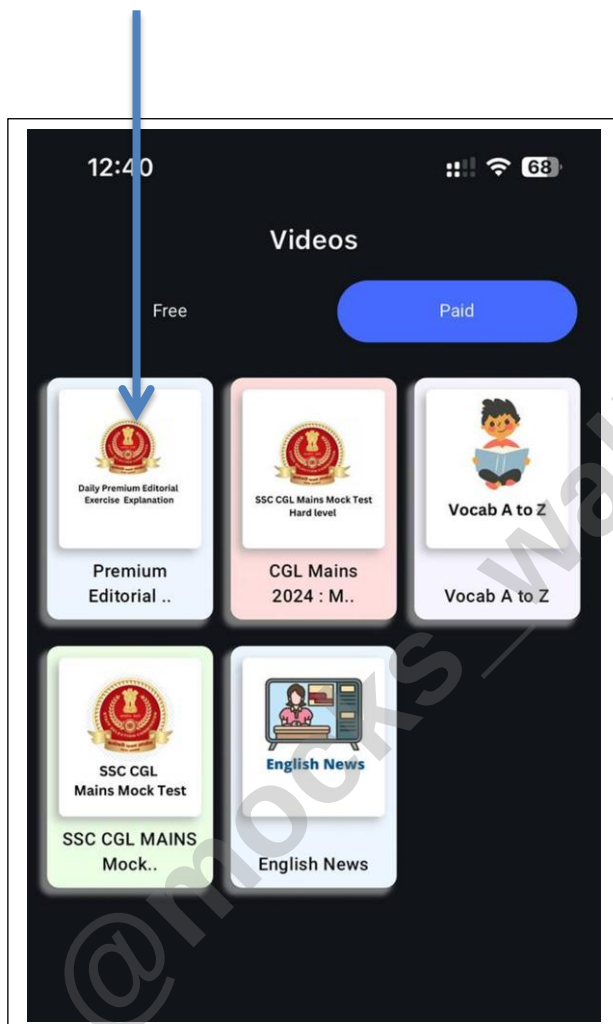
22. **Unresolved** (adjective) – Pending, unsettled, undecided, open, ambiguous
अनसुलझा
23. **Post-disengagement** (noun) – After withdrawal, post-withdrawal, aftermath, post-separation, subsequent
विघटन के बाद की स्थिति
24. **De-escalation** (noun) – Reduction, easing, diminishing, defusing, moderation
तनाव में कमी
25. **Troop** (noun) – Soldiers, forces, army, battalion, military unit
सैनिक
26. **Curb** (noun) – Restriction, limit, restraint, control, check
प्रतिबंध
27. **A stumbling block** (noun) – Obstacle, barrier, hindrance, hurdle, impediment
बाधा
28. **Convey** (verb) – Communicate, express, relay, articulate, transmit
व्यक्त करना
29. **Pointed** (adjective) – Sharp, direct, explicit, specific, unambiguous
स्पष्ट
30. **Reminder** (noun) – Prompt, cue, alert, notice, notification
याद दिलाना
31. **Separatism** (noun) – Secessionism, division, disunion, dissociation, autonomy
अलगाववाद
32. **Extremism** (noun) – Radicalism, fanaticism, militancy, fundamentalism, zealotry
उग्रवाद
33. **Turbulent** (adjective) – Unstable, chaotic, stormy, disturbed, unsettled
अशांत
34. **Order** (noun) – System, arrangement, structure, stability, regime
व्यवस्था
35. **Unpredictable** (adjective) – Uncertain, volatile, erratic, capricious, unstable
अप्रत्याशित
36. **Occupant** (noun) – Inhabitant, holder, resident, possessor, dweller
पदाधिकारी
37. **Pas de deux** (noun) – Collaboration, duet, partnership, interplay, coordination
दो लोगों की साझेदारी
38. **Pragmatic** (adjective) – Practical, realistic, sensible, rational, logical
व्यावहारिक
39. **Threaten** (verb) – Endanger, menace, intimidate, jeopardize, warn
धमकी देना
40. **Sanction** (verb) – Penalize, punish, impose, ban, restrict
प्रतिबंध लगाना
41. **Underscore** (verb) – Emphasize, highlight, stress, accentuate, reinforce
ज़ोर देना
42. **Trade deficit** (noun) – the amount by which the cost of a country's imports exceeds the value of its exports.
व्यापार घाटा
43. **The latter** (noun) – Here it refers to 'China'.

44. **Scale up** (phrasal verb) – Increase, expand, boost, upgrade, intensify बढ़ाना
45. **Quantum computing** (noun) a type of computation that leverages quantum mechanics to perform complex calculations क्वांटम कंप्यूटिंग
46. **Steadily** (adverb) – Gradually, consistently, continuously, regularly, firmly निरंतर
47. **Strengthen** (verb) – Reinforce, boost, fortify, support, consolidate मजबूत करना
48. **Lure** (verb) – Attract, entice, tempt, seduce, draw लुभाना
49. **Fold** (noun) – Group, alliance, organization, community, circle समूह
50. **Vigilant** (adjective) – Watchful, alert, cautious, attentive, observant सतर्क
51. **Dialogue** (noun) – Discussion, talk, conversation, communication, negotiation संवाद
52. **Leverage** (noun) – Advantage, influence, power, control, sway प्रभाव
53. **Get one's own house in order** (phrase) – Settle issues, reform oneself, reorganize, fix internal problems, self-improve अपनी समस्याओं को ठीक करना
54. **Accelerate** (verb) – Hasten, speed up, quicken, advance, rush तेज करना
55. **Foster** (verb) – Encourage, promote, nurture, support, develop बढ़ावा देना
56. **Criticise** (verb) – Condemn, denounce, censure, disapprove, attack आलोचना करना
57. **Outreach** (noun) – Engagement, communication, contact, diplomacy, advocacy संपर्क
58. **Calibrated** (adjective) – Measured, calculated, planned, adjusted, deliberate संतुलित
59. **Diplomacy** (noun) – Negotiation, tact, foreign affairs, statecraft, mediation कूटनीति
60. **Front** (noun) – Field, domain, sector, aspect, area क्षेत्र
61. **Neighbourhood** (noun) – Vicinity, locality, surrounding region, nearby area, proximity पड़ोस
62. **Gain the upper hand** (phrase) – Prevail, dominate, take control, outmaneuver, overpower बढ़त पाना
63. **Decisive** (adjective) – Conclusive, crucial, final, determining, critical निर्णायक

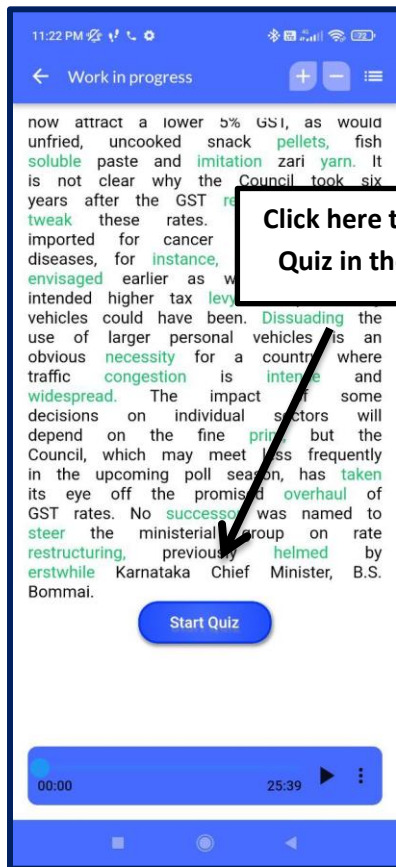
Summary of the Editorial

1. **First Visit Since 2020 Skirmishes** – External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar visited China for the first time since the 2020 military standoff along the Line of Actual Control (LAC).
2. **High-Level Engagements** – He met President Xi Jinping, Foreign Minister Wang Yi, and Liu Jianchao, signaling intent to improve India-China ties.
3. **Symbol of Thaw** – The visit, along with earlier meetings like Modi-Xi at BRICS 2023, indicates a thaw or warming in bilateral relations.
4. **Ongoing Diplomatic Exchanges** – Recent visits to China by NSA Ajit Doval, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, and Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri show rising diplomatic momentum.
5. **Bilateral Improvements** – Positive steps include easing visa rules, plans to resume direct flights, and restarting the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra.
6. **Long-Term Perspective Urged** – Jaishankar emphasized using a "far-seeing lens" to rebuild the India-China relationship.
7. **Border Issues Remain** – Despite disengagement, there has been no actual de-escalation — forward troop withdrawals at the LAC haven't begun.
8. **Economic Frictions Persist** – China continues restrictive trade practices, including curbs on rare earth exports and advanced tech machinery.
9. **Strategic Messaging** – Jaishankar reminded China at the SCO that the group stands against terrorism, separatism, and extremism.
10. **Geopolitical Realism** – Re-engagement with China is seen as pragmatic, especially amid Western sanctions targeting India and China's ties with Russia.
11. **China's Competitive Posture** – China still views India as a competitor, not a partner — as shown in its military cooperation with Pakistan and Operation Sindoor.
12. **Widening Power Gap** – India has a \$100 billion trade deficit with China, which also leads in defence capability, AI, quantum tech, and rare earth dominance.
13. **Strategic Encroachment** – Beijing is extending influence in South Asia, pulling key nations like Bangladesh closer to its orbit.
14. **Need for Vigilance** – India must be alert and strategically proactive to avoid being outpaced by China regionally.
15. **Strengthen Internally and Regionally** – India must focus on internal reforms, technological growth, and unity while widening global and regional partnerships to counterbalance China.

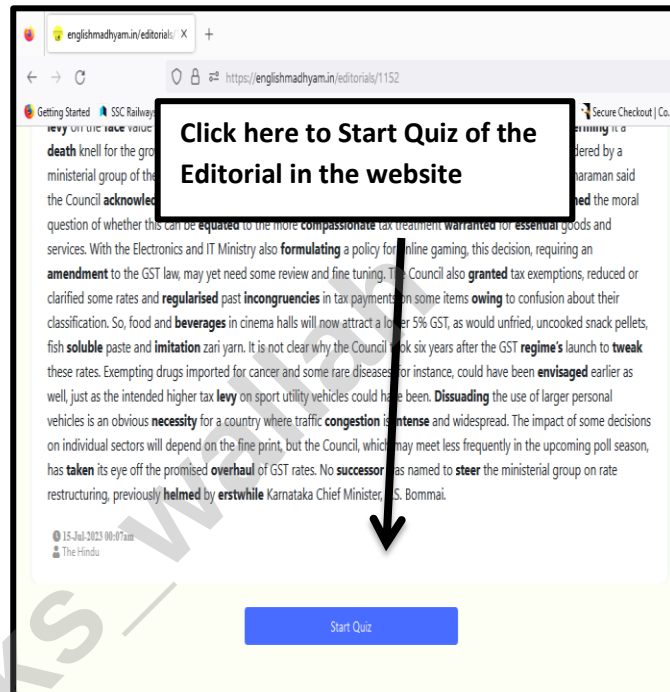
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